



Fiona Stanley Fremantle Hospitals Group

Policy and Procedure

Code Black Mental Health

Reference #: FSH-MENH-POL-0014

Scope

Site	Service/Department/Unit	Disciplines
Fiona Stanley Hospital	Mental Health Service	Nursing, Medical, Allied Health, Safety and Incident Management Services (SIMS), Facilities Management.
Exclusion: Cockburn Health.		

1. Introduction

A code black must be activated at any time a staff member feels threatened or at imminent risk of physical harm from another individual. In the event of a duress activation in the Mental Health Unit (MHU) or the community, this document outlines the procedure for duress activation and response for the MHU and requesting assistance in the community to ensure timely emergency assistance.

2. Terminology

Code Black	Procedure for the response to an act of violence, or threat thereof. The method whereby staff members who feel that their personal safety, or the safety of others, is under threat can summon a prompt response from appropriately trained personnel.	
Personal Duress Alarm		Also called Real Time Location Services (RTLS) tag, is used to promote safety of the individual either through the use of the in-built duress alarm function or by locating an unaccounted individual.

Emergency plus application		Community based emergency system for use in a duress situation. It can be accessed by downloading an application onto a work issued Smart phone. Enables staff working with or visiting patients in the community to contact emergency services via 000. It gives the clinician their location details to provide to emergency services.
Official visitors	For the purposes of this procedure includes: • Carer and Consumer Advisory Group representatives • Mental Health Advocates • Volunteers • Mental Health Tribunal • Other external visitors	

3. Policy

- All FSH mental health staff will be orientated to the Code black Mental Health Policy and Procedure on commencement of employment.
- All staff working in mental health will have undertaken the appropriate level of aggression prevention and intervention (API) training.
- All inpatient MHU staff are allocated a mobile personal duress alarm (RTLS) and trained in its use.
- Casual/agency nursing staff will be allocated a duress alarm and swipe card by the Nurse Unit Manager (NUM) / HOOT CNM at the commencement of the shift. Casual /agency staff will be requested to sign out when they receive their duress and swipe and sign in when they return them.
- All staff in the inpatient wards must wear personal duress devices at all times.

Inpatient staff will test their personal duress alarm (RTLS) at least monthly.

All staff are responsible for ensuring the instant notifier is turned on in the work area.

- Staff working with or visiting patients in the community will have access to an emergency activation system on their work issued smart phone, this includes:
 - Nursing
 - Allied Health
 - Medical

4. Types of Duress Alarms

4.1. Wall mounted duress alarms

- Wall mounted emergency buttons are located on each ward within the MHU and in the reception area
- This will activate an audible alarm and a visible message be displayed on the annunciators in the following locations:
 - Staff Base – Assessment Unit
 - Staff Bases 1 and 2 - Youth Unit
 - Staff Base - Mother and Baby Unit
 - Staff Room – MHU
- Follow me lights direct staff to the duress location.
- Once the situation is under control the 'Cancel Button' can be used to deactivate the Emergency button.



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4.2. Fixed duress alarms

- Fixed duress alarms are fitted under the desk in the Nurses Station in all wards
- Following activation, nursing staff must request SIMS to reset the fixed alarm.

4.3. Emergency Plus application

- Emergency system enabling staff working with or visiting patients in the community to activate an emergency response using their work phone to call 000. Refer to Section 6.

4.4. Personal Duress Alarms (RTLS tags)

- SIMS administration staff issue personal duress alarms (RTLS) to hospital employees with their identification badge at the commencement of employment.
- Are provided to all staff working in the:
 - MHU
 - The Learning Centre
 - Outpatient Clinics in State Rehabilitation Service B.
- Each personal duress alarm is unique and is configured with the staff members HE number.
- In an emergency the SIMS team can locate the staff member via their personal duress alarm (RTLS).
- The range for the personal duress alarm (RTLS) covers the entire site and every building level.

- The personal duress alarm (RTLS) must be worn in an easily accessible location not in pockets or underneath clothing.
- To test the duress alarm:
 - Press the orange button three times in rapid succession.
 - When pressed three times the red light will start to flash for several seconds.
- An email will be sent to the staff member confirming that the test was successful and the battery level status
 - If an email is not received, repeat the test and if the email is not sent a second time, contact the helpdesk to generate a work order for SIMS Admin to replace the duress alarm.
- Batteries last for approximately two years but once the battery level reaches 20% staff are advised to contact the helpdesk to generate a work order for SIMS to replace the alarm.
- If the personal duress alarm (RTLS tag) is lost or if it becomes damaged, staff must contact the helpdesk to generate a work order for SIMS to replace the alarm.

5. Code Black Response - Inpatient

To activate a Code Black either:

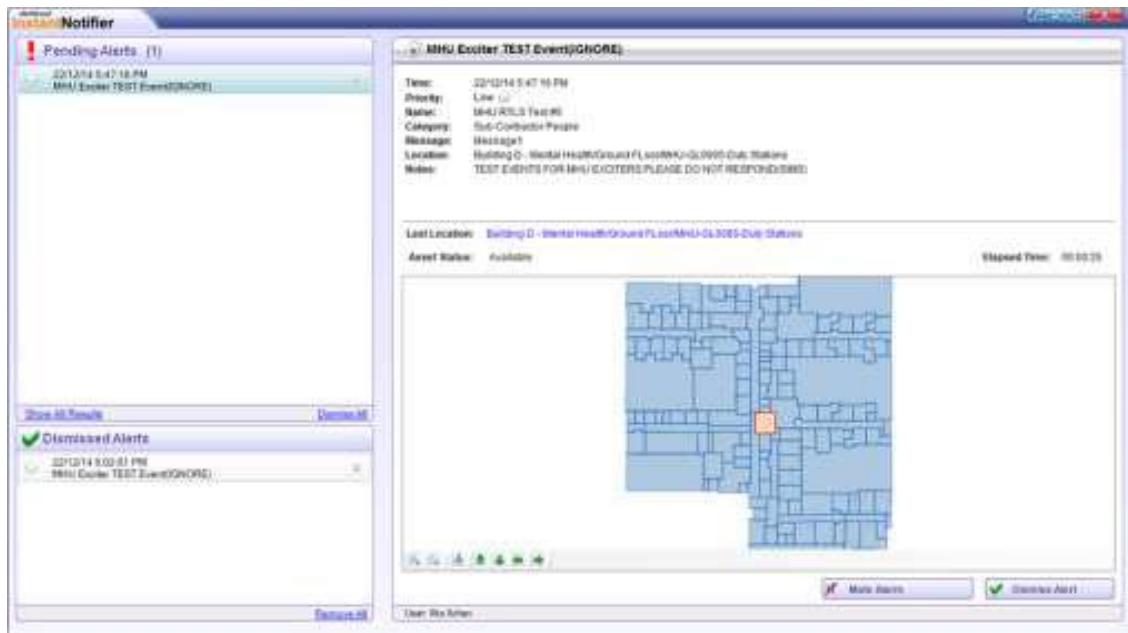
- Dial “55” stating:
 - Code Black
 - Giving a brief description
 - Location
 - Name and title
- Activate a mobile personal duress alarm (RTLS) by:
 - Pressing the orange button for 10 seconds. The red light activates on the tag and the light will flash for several seconds.
 - Ensure that the microphone on the front cover of the tag is uncovered.
- Press a wall mounted or fixed duress alarm



When the mobile personal duress alarm (RTLS tag) is activated:

- Message sent to duress response team via Olinqua Paging Smartphones.
- An Instant Notifier - audible pending alert alarm will sound:
 - in the SIMS Control Room staffed 24/7 and

- a map of the staff member's location will be displayed on computer screens in the MHU to notify staff of the duress location
- AeroScout – Instant Notifier Pop up Screen



This will initiate the following Code Black response:

- FSH Emergency Response Team (ERT) including:
 - SIMS
- MHU Code Black Tresponse Team including:
 - Assessment Unit - Shift Coordinator
 - Youth Unit - Shift Coordinator
 - Mother & Baby Unit - Shift Coordinator
 - Registrar on duty
 - Nurse Unit Manager (in hours)
 - Youth Unit / Mother & Baby Unit – CNS (in hours)
 - HOOT CNM (out of hours)
- Only staff designated as members of the duress response team will respond directly to the location of the emergency.
- Staff responding to a duress alarm will not put themselves at risk and will wait until adequate staff are present to assess and manage the situation.
- Staff not designated to the duress response team will not respond to the emergency unless requested to do so.

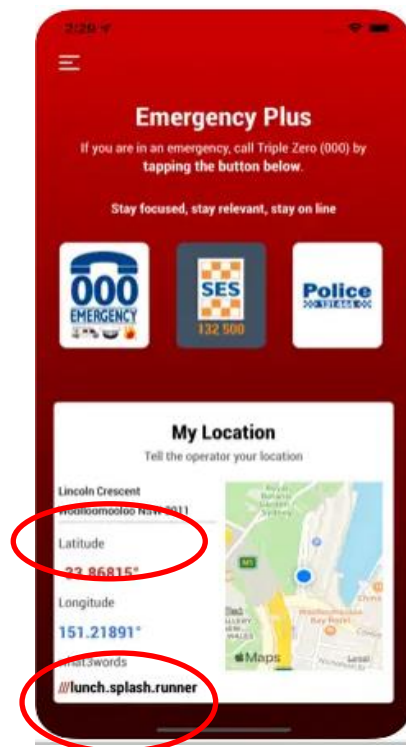
- All other clinical and non-clinical staff will provide back up support for any emergency situation and support the supervision for patients and visitors not involved in the incident
- An alert will be sent to a SIMS officer closest to the location who will attend.
- On arrival, the attending SIMS officer/s will provide appropriate support as directed by clinical staff to manage the situation.

In the event that clinical staff cannot manage the situation, for example, the patient has a weapon; SIMS will take carriage of the situation and call WA Police if necessary.

- Once the situation is safe, SIMS will stand down the Code black and dismiss the alert on the instant notifier. Clinical staff to provide SIMS staff with a patient identification label.

6. Code Black Response - community

- Staff working with or visiting patients in the community will have access to a community-based emergency system.
- Staff members will carry or be in the company of another staff member with a work issued Smart phone with Emergency plus application downloaded on their person.
- Staff will be instructed on the use of the community-based system prior to working in the community.
- Staff will update the app as prompted by the software system
- A duress in the community will be responded to by staff calling 000:
 - Opening the Emergency+ app
 - Tapping on the relevant icon e.g. 000 Emergency which will connect you to a Triple zero call taker
 - When asked for the location read out street location where available or the 3 words displayed at the bottom of the screen in the 'My location' section
 - help will be sent to the exact location



7. Follow up

- Following an incident involving the activation of the duress alarm, staff involved will complete all relevant documentation:
 - Clinical Incident Monitoring System (CIMS) forms
 - Critical Incident and Combined Hazard or Incident Report (CHoIR) form
 - document in the DMR.
 - PSOLIS alerts
- Following a Code Black a debriefing, support and review process will be provided for the staff involved in the incident and will take place as soon as possible following the incident.
- Staff members will also be provided with an opportunity to debrief with their supervisor/trusted mentor.
- Staff will be supported to access the Employee Assistance Program and/or Staff Psychological Wellbeing and Support Program if required.

8. Compliance/performance monitoring

- The Nurse Unit Manager will monitor compliance for this policy document via routine clinical incident reviews.
- The FSFHG Workplace Aggression and Violence Working Group review Code Black data monthly to identify trends and new high risk areas.

- The Performance and Corporate Leadership Committee will review Code Black data monthly to identify trends and new high risk areas.
- Aggression Prevention and Intervention training mandatory training compliance is monitored by the Performance and Corporate Leadership Committee monthly.

9. Related policy documents

- SMHS:
 - [WHS Hazard and Incident Management](#)
 - [Community / Home Visiting SMHS 131](#)
 - [Duress Alarm Systems SMHS: 116](#)
 - [Critical Incident Stress Management](#)
- FSFHG:
 - Restrictive Practices (FSFH-MENH-POL-0019)

10. Related documents

- FSH Personal Duress Alarm (RTLS tag) Guide

11. Related standards

- NSQHS Standards
 - Clinical Governance
 - Recognising and responding to acute deterioration

12. Authorisation

EXECUTIVE SPONSOR: Nurse Director, Service 5					
Version	Date Issued	Compiled/Revised By	Committee/Consumer Group Consulted	Endorsed By	Revision due
1	01/2015	HOS FSH MH		Co- Directors Service 3	01/2017
2	05/2019	NUM MHU	MHS SQR Committee	FSFHG Policy Committee	05/2021
3	05/2021	CNS, Clinical Improvement	S5 SQR Committee	FSFHG Policy Committee	05/2024
4	06/2023	CNS, Clinical Improvement	S5 SQR Committee	S5 SQR Committee	05/2024
5	08/2023	CNS, Clinical Improvement	S5 SQR Committee	S5 SQR Committee	05/2024
6	8/2024	CNS, Clinical Improvement	S5 SQR Committee	S5 SQR Committee	08/2027
7	09/2024	SQR Lead MH	Minor Update, No change to review date	S5 SQR Committee	08/2027